ENGLISH · CLASS 9–10 STUDY NOTEBOOK

Articulate

A short reading to build vocabulary you'll actually use, plus proverbs, grammar fixes, spelling rules, and practical tips for speaking and writing with more confidence.

Highlighted words in the passage are explained in the Word Bank just below it.

PART 1

Warm-Up Reading

Read it once for the story. Read it again and notice each highlighted word.

Every year, our school's Annual Day is the moment when many small efforts **arise** into one big celebration. This year, the planning committee decided to make the event more **inclusive**, inviting students from every class and section to take part — not just the usual few. What began as separate ideas for dance, drama, and debate soon became a **convergence** of talent, all pointing toward the same evening.

At first, many students found it hard to **comprehend** how such different acts could fit into a single show. Ritu, our head girl, had to **articulate** the plan during morning assembly, explaining each team's role in simple, confident sentences. Her calm **perspective** helped everyone see the bigger picture.

The weeks that followed tested our **perseverance**. Rehearsals ran late, costumes tore, and the speakers failed the night before the show — problems that felt almost **inevitable** in a project this size. Yet nobody gave up. Our teachers reminded us that **curiosity** and teamwork, not perfection, make an event memorable.

On the final night, as the lights came up on a stage full of students who had barely known each other two months earlier, it was clear how much they had grown. Parents in the audience later said the show made them **contemplate** how much young people can achieve when given a real chance. For our small school, that evening was proof that an inclusive, well-planned effort is truly **indispensable** to building confidence — in students and teachers alike.

11 words to know are highlighted above. All of them are explained in the Word Bank below.

PART 2

Word Bank

The words from the passage, in order — how to say them, what they mean, and their word family.

arise VERB uh-RIZE

To happen, start, or come into existence.

> *"A problem can arise when nobody plans ahead."*

Family: arose (past), arisen (past participle)

inclusive ADJECTIVE in-KLOO-siv

Including everyone; leaving no one out.

> *"A good teacher runs an inclusive classroom."*

Family: include (v), inclusion (n), inclusively (adv)

convergence NOUN kuhn-VUR-juhns

The coming together of different things toward one point.

> *"The convergence of music and technology created a new industry."*

Family: converge (v), convergent (adj)

comprehend VERB kom-pri-HEND

To understand something completely.

> *"It took me a while to comprehend the question."*

Family: comprehension (n), comprehensible (adj)

articulate VERB / ADJ. ar-TIK-yuh-layt

To express an idea clearly (verb); speaking clearly and confidently (adjective).

> *"She articulated her opinion without hesitation."*

Family: articulation (n), articulately (adv)

perspective NOUN per-SPEK-tiv

A particular way of thinking about or seeing something.

> *"Travelling gives you a new perspective on life."*

Family: —

perseverance NOUN pur-suh-VEER-uhns

Continued effort and patience despite difficulty.

> *"Her perseverance helped her clear the exam on the second try."*

Family: persevere (v), persevering (adj)

inevitable ADJECTIVE in-EV-i-tuh-buhl

Certain to happen; impossible to avoid.

> *"Change is inevitable as technology grows."*

Family: inevitably (adv), inevitability (n)

curiosity NOUN kyoor-ee-OS-i-tee

A strong desire to know or learn something.

> *"Curiosity pushed her to ask more questions in class."*

Family: curious (adj), curiously (adv)

contemplate VERB KON-tuhm-playt

To think about something carefully for a long time.

> *"He sat by the window, contemplating his future."*

Family: contemplation (n), contemplative (adj)

indispensable ADJECTIVE in-dis-PEN-suh-buhl

Too important to do without; essential.

> *"Daily practice is indispensable if you want to speak fluently."*

Family: dispensable (opposite)

PART 3

A Few More Good Words

Not in the passage, but worth owning by Class 10 — they show up often in essays, interviews, and comprehension papers.

diverse
made up of many different types

empathy
understanding another person's feelings

thrive
to grow or develop very well

illuminate
to make something clear or easy to follow

substantial
large in size, value, or importance

humble
not proud, despite success

PART 4

Vocabulary Builder

About 260 more words worth knowing, grouped by theme so they're easier to learn than a random list. Read one group a day rather than all at once.

THINKING & UNDERSTANDING

analyze — examine in detail; **assume** — accept as true without proof; **clarify** — make something clearer; **deduce** — work out from reasoning; **evaluate** — judge the value of something; **hypothesis** — an idea to be tested; **infer** — conclude from evidence; **interpret** — explain the meaning of; **justify** — give good reasons for; **perceive** — become aware of, notice; **ponder** — think over carefully; **rational** — based on logic, not emotion; **reflect** — think deeply about something; **speculate** — form a theory without full proof.

SPEAKING & COMMUNICATING

address — to speak to, or deal with; **convey** — communicate an idea or feeling; **emphasize** — give special importance to; **persuade** — convince someone of something; **converse** — to talk with someone; **debate** — discuss formally, with opposing views; **negotiate** — discuss to reach an agreement; **narrate** — tell a story or give an account; **quote** — repeat someone's exact words; **remark** — say something as a comment; **imply** — suggest without saying directly; **hint** — give a small clue; **elaborate** — explain in more detail; **paraphrase** — restate in your own words.

DESCRIBING PEOPLE & QUALITIES

ambitious — determined to succeed; **arrogant** — having an exaggerated sense of importance; **cautious** — careful to avoid risk; **compassionate** — showing concern for others; **confident** — sure of oneself; **courteous** — polite and respectful; **diligent** — careful and hard-working; **disciplined** — controlled, following rules well; **eager**

— keen and enthusiastic; **generous** — willing to give freely; **genuine** — real, sincere, not fake; **gracious** — kind and courteous; **loyal** — faithful and dependable; **meticulous** — very careful about details; **modest** — not boastful about achievements; **optimistic** — hopeful about the future; **pessimistic** — expecting the worst; **resilient** — able to recover quickly from difficulty; **sincere** — honest, not pretending; **tactful** — careful not to upset others; **tolerant** — accepting of different views or people; **versatile** — able to do many things well; **vigilant** — watchful and alert; **witty** — cleverly humorous.

SIZE, DEGREE & AMOUNT

abundant — existing in large quantities; **adequate** — enough for the purpose; **ample** — more than enough; **considerable** — fairly large in amount; **excessive** — more than necessary; **immense** — extremely large; **minimal** — the smallest amount possible; **moderate** — average, not extreme; **negligible** — too small to matter; **numerous** — many; **scarce** — not enough, rare; **significant** — important, large enough to notice; **sufficient** — enough for a need; **tremendous** — very great in amount; **vast** — extremely large in area or amount.

CHANGE & GROWTH

adapt — adjust to new conditions; **transform** — change completely; **evolve** — develop gradually over time; **enhance** — improve the quality of; **deteriorate** — become worse; **diminish** — become or make smaller; **expand** — grow larger; **fluctuate** — rise and fall irregularly; **decline** — become smaller, weaker, or worse; **accelerate** — speed up; **escalate** — increase rapidly, become more serious; **emerge** — come into existence, become known; **flourish** — grow or develop successfully; **progress** — move forward or improve; **regress** — go back to an earlier state; **revive** — bring back to life or use; **sustain** — keep something going over time.

CAUSE, EFFECT & ARGUMENT

consequence — a result of an action; **contribute** — help cause or add to; **correlate** — have a mutual relationship; **derive** — obtain something from a source; **entail** — involve as a necessary result; **factor** — one cause among several; **impact** — a strong effect; **influence** — the power to affect something; **outcome** — the result of an event; **phenomenon** — a remarkable fact or event; **prerequisite** — something required beforehand; **repercussion** — an indirect, often unwanted, effect; **trigger** — cause something to happen; **undermine** — weaken gradually; **undergo** — experience a process or change; **warrant** — to justify or make necessary.

AGREEMENT, DISAGREEMENT & OPINION

acknowledge — accept or admit the truth of; **advocate** — publicly support an idea; **contradict** — say the opposite of; **controversial** — causing public disagreement; **criticize** — point out faults; **debatable** — open to discussion, not certain; **dispute** — argue about something; **endorse** — publicly support or approve; **object** — express disagreement; **oppose** — be against something; **refute** — prove something wrong; **skeptical** — doubtful, not easily convinced; **unanimous** — everyone agreeing; **valid** — well-grounded and reasonable.

EMOTIONS & REACTIONS

anxious — worried or nervous; **apprehensive** — fearful about the future; **delighted** — very pleased; **devastated** — extremely upset; **ecstatic** — extremely happy; **frustrated** — upset by an obstacle; **grateful** — feeling thankful; **indifferent** — having no particular interest; **overwhelmed** — affected by too much at once; **relieved** — no longer worried, after stress; **reluctant** — unwilling to do something; **resentful** — feeling bitter about unfair treatment; **sympathetic** — showing understanding for others' feelings; **content** — satisfied, at peace; **weary** — very tired.

EFFORT, CHALLENGES & SUCCESS

accomplish — succeed in completing something; **achieve** — reach a goal through effort; **ambition** — a strong desire to succeed; **arduous** — very difficult, needing great effort; **aspire** — hope to achieve something; **dedicated** — committed to a task; **endeavor** — a serious attempt; **obstacle** — something that blocks progress; **overcome** — succeed in dealing with a problem; **pursue** — follow or work toward a goal; **strive** — make a great

effort; **struggle** — try hard against difficulty; **tenacity** — determination, not giving up; **triumph** — a great success or victory; **setback** — a difficulty that delays progress.

TIME, FREQUENCY & SEQUENCE

occasionally — from time to time; **frequently** — often; **simultaneously** — at the same time; **subsequently** — afterward; **eventually** — in the end; **gradually** — slowly, over time; **initially** — at first; **persistently** — continuing firmly despite difficulty; **periodically** — at regular intervals; **ultimately** — finally, in the end; **momentarily** — for a very short time; **henceforth** — from now on; **meanwhile** — at the same time; **thereafter** — after that.

VALUE & IMPORTANCE

crucial — extremely important; **essential** — absolutely necessary; **fundamental** — forming a basic foundation; **integral** — necessary to make something complete; **paramount** — more important than anything else; **pivotal** — central and very important; **priceless** — too valuable to price; **relevant** — connected to the matter at hand; **trivial** — of little importance; **valuable** — worth a lot; **vital** — necessary for life or success; **worthwhile** — deserving time or effort.

SOCIETY & RELATIONSHIPS

community — a group living in the same area; **cooperation** — working together; **equality** — being equal in status or rights; **harmony** — peaceful agreement; **hierarchy** — a system of ranking; **integration** — combining into a whole; **interaction** — activity or communication between people; **prejudice** — an unfair opinion formed in advance; **solidarity** — unity based on shared goals; **tradition** — a long-established custom; **unity** — the state of being united; **welfare** — health, happiness, and well-being; **civic** — relating to a city or its citizens.

IDEAS, KNOWLEDGE & LEARNING

concept — an abstract idea; **curriculum** — the subjects taught in a course; **discipline** — training that builds self-control; **enlighten** — give someone understanding; **expertise** — skill or knowledge in a field; **insight** — a clear understanding of something; **literacy** — the ability to read and write; **notion** — an idea or belief; **principle** — a basic truth or rule; **theory** — an explanation based on reasoning; **wisdom** — the quality of having good judgement.

ENVIRONMENT & WORLD

conserve — protect from harm or waste; **ecosystem** — a community of living things and their environment; **pollution** — harmful substances in the environment; **resource** — a supply that can be used; **sustainable** — able to continue without harming the future; **renewable** — able to be replaced naturally; **biodiversity** — variety of life in an area; **climate** — the general weather pattern of a place; **deplete** — reduce the amount of something; **habitat** — the natural home of a plant or animal.

WORDS FOR ESSAYS & ACADEMIC WRITING

context — the background of a situation; **criteria** — standards for judging something; **evidence** — facts that support an idea; **feature** — a notable part or quality; **framework** — a basic structure of ideas; **method** — a planned way of doing something; **objective** — a goal (noun); unbiased (adjective); **scenario** — a possible sequence of events; **statistic** — a piece of numerical data; **strategy** — a plan to achieve a goal; **aspect** — one part or feature of something; **approach** — a way of dealing with something; **implication** — a possible effect or result.

EVERYDAY ACTION VERBS (FORMAL)

acquire — gain or obtain; **allocate** — distribute for a purpose; **collaborate** — work jointly with others; **commence** — begin; **compile** — put together from various sources; **conduct** — carry out an activity; **delegate** — give a task to someone else; **execute** — carry out a plan fully; **facilitate** — make an action easier; **implement** — put a plan

into action; **initiate** — start something; **maintain** — keep something going at the same level; **obtain** — get possession of; **participate** — take part in something; **prioritize** — treat as more important; **recommend** — suggest as good or suitable; **resolve** — settle a problem firmly; **utilize** — make practical use of.

LINKING WORDS FOR WRITING

nevertheless — in spite of that; **nonetheless** — despite that; **furthermore** — in addition, also; **consequently** — as a result; **whereas** — while, in contrast; **albeit** — although; **notwithstanding** — despite; **likewise** — in the same way; **thus** — therefore, as a result; **hence** — for this reason.

ADJECTIVES FOR ARGUMENTS & ESSAYS

compelling — convincing and powerful; **convincing** — able to make someone believe; **credible** — believable, trustworthy; **feasible** — possible to do; **plausible** — seeming reasonable; **profound** — very deep or intense; **subtle** — not obvious, delicate; **superficial** — only on the surface, not deep; **ambiguous** — having more than one possible meaning; **coherent** — logical and consistent; **comprehensive** — complete, including everything needed; **concise** — clear, in few words; **redundant** — no longer needed; **thorough** — complete and careful.

PART 5

Sayings Worth Knowing

Proverbs and idioms native speakers use often — and examiners like to see you understand.

Elephant in the room

An obvious problem everyone notices but avoids discussing.

"No one mentioned his resignation — it was the elephant in the room."

Actions speak louder than words

What you do matters more than what you say.

"He didn't apologise, but he helped clean up — actions speak louder than words."

A blessing in disguise

Something that seems bad at first but turns out well.

"Missing that bus was a blessing in disguise — I met an old friend at the next stop."

Hit the nail on the head

To describe a problem or solution exactly and correctly.

"When she said we needed more practice, she hit the nail on the head."

Break the ice

To ease tension or start a conversation in an awkward situation.

"He told a joke to break the ice before the interview."

Once in a blue moon

Something that happens very rarely.

"We only meet once in a blue moon these days."

The ball is in your court

It's now your turn to act or decide.

"I've sent my proposal — the ball is in your court now."

Every cloud has a silver lining	There is something good hidden in every bad situation. *"He lost the match but gained confidence — every cloud has a silver lining."*
Practice makes perfect	Regular practice leads to steady improvement. *"She was nervous on stage at first, but after months of debate club, practice makes perfect."*
Better late than never	It's better to do or arrive at something late than not at all. *"He submitted the form a week after the deadline, but better late than never."*
Don't judge a book by its cover	Don't form an opinion about someone or something based on appearance alone. *"The new student seemed shy at first — don't judge a book by its cover, he turned out to be the best debater in class."*
The pen is mightier than the sword	Words and ideas can influence people more than force or violence. *"The editorial changed public opinion overnight, proving the pen is mightier than the sword."*
Slow and steady wins the race	Consistent, careful effort succeeds better than rushing. *"He revised a little every day instead of cramming — slow and steady wins the race."*
A picture is worth a thousand words	An image can express an idea more powerfully than a long description. *"The photograph of the flooded village said more than any news report — a picture is worth a thousand words."*
Two heads are better than one	People working together usually find better solutions than one person alone. *"We were stuck on the project until Meera joined in — two heads are better than one."*
Where there's a will, there's a way	Enough determination will help you find a solution to any problem. *"She had no coach and no equipment, yet she trained anyway — where there's a will, there's a way."*
Honesty is the best policy	Telling the truth is wiser than lying, even when it's difficult. *"He admitted his mistake to the teacher right away, believing honesty is the best policy."*
Bite the bullet	To face a difficult or unpleasant situation with courage. *"She hated public speaking, but she bit the bullet and gave the farewell speech."*

Go the extra mile	To make an effort beyond what is expected. *"The volunteers went the extra mile, staying back after hours to finish the relief work."*
Speak of the devil	Said when a person who was just being discussed suddenly appears. *"We were just talking about Arjun — speak of the devil, here he comes."*
Take it with a grain of salt	Don't take something too seriously, especially if the source may be unreliable. *"He tends to exaggerate his scores, so take his story with a grain of salt."*
The grass is always greener on the other side	Other people's lives or situations always seem better than our own, whether or not that's true. *"He wanted to switch schools until he realised the grass is always greener on the other side."*

PART 6

Grammar Worth Getting Right

Common slips at this level, shown as wrong-then-right so the correction sticks.

1. Simple past vs. present perfect

- ✗ I have watched that movie yesterday.
- ✓ I watched that movie yesterday.

Use simple past with a specific past time (yesterday, last week). Use present perfect when no exact time is given: "I have watched that movie already."

2. Articles (a / an / the)

- ✗ I want to become a engineer.
- ✓ I want to become an engineer.
- ✗ He is best student in class.
- ✓ He is the best student in class.

Use "an" before a vowel sound. Superlatives (best, tallest, most) almost always take "the".

3. Countable vs. uncountable nouns

- ✗ She gave me many informations.
- ✓ She gave me a lot of information.

Information, advice, and furniture are uncountable — no plural "s" and no "many".

4. Doubling the comparative

✗ This book is more better than that one.

✓ This book is better than that one.

"Better" and "worse" are already comparative — never add "more" in front.

5. Prepositions of time

✓ in May, in 2024 · on Monday, on 15 August · at 6 o'clock, at noon

Bigger blocks of time take "in"; specific days/dates take "on"; exact clock times take "at".

6. Linking words for more mature writing

✗ It was raining. But we went out to play.

✓ It was raining. However, we went out to play.

Swap plain "and/but/so" for however, moreover, therefore, and although in formal writing.

7. Reported speech (tense shifts back one step)

✗ She said, "I am tired." → She said that I am tired.

✓ She said, "I am tired." → She said (that) she was tired.

Present becomes past, and pronouns change to match the speaker being described.

PART 7

Speaking With Confidence

Fluent speakers aren't the ones with the biggest vocabulary — they're the ones who control pace, structure, and word choice.

1. **Slow down on purpose.** Speaking about 15% slower than feels natural gives your brain time to pick the right word, and it makes you sound more confident, not less.

2. **Plan the idea before the sentence.** Decide your whole point first, instead of starting a sentence and hoping it finishes well.

3. **Use Point → Reason → Example → Point.** This simple structure keeps an answer organised even when you're nervous, in a debate or an interview.

4. **Pause instead of saying "um".** A short silence sounds thoughtful; a filler word sounds unsure.

5. **Choose the clear word over the big word.** "Comprehend" is fine, but if "understand" comes to you faster, use it. Clarity beats showing off.

6 **Think in English — don't translate.** Translating from your first language in your head slows you down and often scrambles word order.

7 **Read one paragraph aloud daily.** A newspaper editorial works well. Note 2–3 unfamiliar words each time and add them to a vocabulary notebook.

8 **Record yourself for one minute.** Pick any topic and speak, then listen back — you'll notice filler words and pace issues you never hear while speaking.

PART 8

Useful Phrases & Openers

Ready-made phrases for introductions, opinions, and conclusions — in speech and in writing.

INTRODUCING YOURSELF (SPEAKING)

"Good morning/afternoon, everyone. My name is ___ and I study in Class ___." · "It's a pleasure to be here today." · "I'd like to start by telling you a little about myself." · "I come from ___, and I'm especially interested in ___." · "Thank you for giving me this opportunity to introduce myself."

OPENING AN ESSAY OR SPEECH

"In today's fast-changing world, ..." · "Have you ever wondered why...?" · "It is often said that..." · "One of the most debated issues today is..." · "Imagine a world where..." · "According to a recent report, ..." · "There is no denying the fact that..." · "From time immemorial, ..." · "It goes without saying that..."

STATING YOUR TOPIC OR PURPOSE

"In this essay, I will discuss..." · "The purpose of this speech is to..." · "Today, I would like to talk about..." · "This essay aims to explore..." · "Let us examine the reasons behind..." · "I will begin by looking at..."

GIVING YOUR OPINION

"In my opinion, ..." · "I strongly believe that..." · "From my point of view, ..." · "It seems to me that..." · "As far as I am concerned, ..." · "Personally, I feel that..."

AGREEING & DISAGREEING (SPEAKING)

"I completely agree with that." · "That's a fair point, however..." · "I see what you mean, but..." · "I'm afraid I have to disagree, because..." · "That's true to some extent, but..." · "I couldn't agree more."

CONCLUDING AN ESSAY OR SPEECH

"In conclusion, ..." · "To sum up, ..." · "Taking everything into account, ..." · "All things considered, ..." · "On a final note, ..." · "To conclude, I would like to say that..."

PART 9

Writing Tips

1 **Outline before you write.** Jot down 3–4 points in order before starting a paragraph or essay.

2 **Vary your sentence length.** Mix short, direct sentences with longer ones so the writing doesn't feel flat.

3 **Swap repeated words for synonyms.** Instead of "good" four times, try effective, valuable, admirable, worthwhile.

4 **Proofread in two separate passes.** Read once only for articles (a/an/the), then once only for verb tense — checking both together misses errors.

PART 10

Spelling Rules That Actually Help

Spelling improves faster with a few rules and a method than with memorising long lists.

1. "i" before "e", except after "c"

✓ believe, friend, niece · after c: receive, ceiling, deceive

Common exceptions to just memorise: weird, seize, science, height.

2. Double the last letter before -ing / -ed (short, stressed words)

✓ stop → stopped, run → running, plan → planned

✗ help → helpped (wrong — "help" ends in two consonants, so don't double)

Rule of thumb: one vowel + one consonant at the end of a short word → double it before -ing/-ed.

3. Drop the silent "e" before -ing, -ed, -able

✓ make → making, hope → hoping, use → usable

✓ but keep the "e" before -ment, -ful: hope → hopeful, excite → excitement

4. Change "y" to "i" before a suffix — unless it starts with "i"

✓ happy → happier, happy → happiness

✓ but play → playing keeps the "y" (a vowel comes before it)

5. Words that sound alike but are spelt differently

✓ their (belongs to them) / there (place) / they're (they are)

✓ its (belongs to it) / it's (it is) · your (belongs to you) / you're (you are)

✓ effect (usually a noun) / affect (usually a verb)

These are the single most common spelling errors even among confident writers.

6. Watch for silent letters

- ✓ k-nee, k-now, w-rite, lis-t-en, hon-est, is-land

Say the word slowly and exaggerate the silent letter in your head while writing it.

7. Break long words into syllables before spelling them

- ✓ com-pre-hend · ar-tic-u-late · in-dis-pen-sa-ble

Say each syllable aloud as you write it, rather than picturing the whole word at once.

8. Use a mnemonic for stubborn words

- ✓ necessary → one Collar, two Sleeves (1 c, 2 s)
- ✓ because → Big Elephants Can Always Understand Small Elephants

Make up your own for any word you keep getting wrong — a silly one sticks best.

9. Practise with Look – Say – Cover – Write – Check

Look at the word closely. Say it aloud, syllable by syllable. Cover it. Write it from memory. Check it against the original — and repeat only the words you got wrong, not the whole list.

Keep this notebook open while you read or write this week — revisit one section a day rather than all at once.

Practice makes perfect.